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GS-1 MAINS SYLLABUS (IN DETAIL)

1. Indian Heritage and Culture

A. Art Forms

- Classical Dances: Bharatanatyam, Kathak, Kathakali, etc.
- Folk Dances: Bihu, Garba, etc.
- Music: Hindustani, Carnatic, Folk music.
- Puppetry: Types, evolution, cultural value.
- Theatre: Sanskrit theatre, Folk theatre (Jatra, Yakshagana, etc.)
- Painting: Cave paintings, Miniature paintings, Mughal, Modern Indian art.
- Martial Arts: Kalaripayattu, Thang-Ta, etc.

B. Literature

- Vedic Literature: Samhitas, Brahmanas, Aranyakas, Upanishads.
- Sangam Literature
- Jain and Buddhist Literature
- Medieval Bhakti and Sufi Literature
- Persian Literature in India
- Modern Indian Literature (Bengali Renaissance, Regional literature)

C. Architecture

- Ancient: Harappan, Mauryan, Gupta, Temple Architecture (Nagara, Dravida, Vesara)
- Medieval: Indo-Islamic (Delhi Sultanate, Mughal)
- Modern: British-era architecture, post-independence architecture (Le Corbusier, Charles Correa)

2. Modern Indian History (Mid-18th Century to Present)

A. British Expansion in India

- Decline of Mughals
- Battles (Plassey, Buxar, Anglo-Mysore, Anglo-Maratha, etc.)
- Subsidiary Alliance, Doctrine of Lapse

B. Colonial Administration & Policies

- Administrative Reforms
- Land Revenue Systems: Zamindari, Ryotwari, Mahalwari
- Economic Impact of British Rule
- Social and Cultural Impact

C. Social and Religious Reform Movements

- Brahmo Samaj, Arya Samaj, Aligarh Movement, etc.
- Role of Women Reformers

D. Key Personalities

- Gandhi, Nehru, Tilak, Bose, Ambedkar, Savitribai Phule, etc.
- Regional leaders and revolutionaries

3. The Freedom Struggle

A. Early Phase

- Revolt of 1857
- Formation of INC (1885), Moderates vs. Extremists

B. Gandhian Phase

- Non-Cooperation, Civil Disobedience, Quit India
- Mass Movements and People Participation

C. Revolutionary Movements

- Bhagat Singh, Chandrasekhar Azad, Anushilan Samiti, HSRA

D. Role of Subalterns

- Tribals, Peasants, Women, Dalits, Regional Movements

E. Contributions from Different Regions

- South India, Northeast, Bengal, Punjab, etc.

4. Post-Independence Consolidation and Reorganization

A. Integration of Princely States

- Sardar Patel's role, Hyderabad, Junagadh, Kashmir

B. Reorganization of States

- Linguistic reorganization (1956)
- NEFA and North-East region integration

C. Challenges to Nation-Building

- Partition & Refugee crisis
- Communalism and Secessionist Movements
- Emergency and Constitutional Amendments

5. History of the World (from 18th Century)

A. 18th Century Revolutions

- American Revolution
- French Revolution
- Haitian Revolution

B. Industrial Revolution

- Causes, Impact on Society, Economy, Labour

C. World Wars

- Causes and Consequences of WWI & WWII
- League of Nations and UN

D. Colonialism & Decolonization

- European Imperialism in Asia & Africa
- Independence Movements (India, Africa, Latin America)

E. Political Philosophies

- Capitalism: Adam Smith, Laissez-faire
- Socialism: Marxism, Soviet Union
- Communism: China, USSR
- Fascism and Nazism

6. Indian Society**A. Salient Features**

- Family, Marriage, Kinship
- Rural vs Urban Society
- Indian value system

B. Diversity of India

- Linguistic, Religious, Cultural, Ethnic Diversity
- Regionalism and Unity in Diversity

7. Role of Women & Related Issues

- Status of Women: Historical and Modern
- Women's Movements and Organizations
- Gender Disparity: Education, Health, Employment
- Laws and Reforms (MTP Act, Domestic Violence, etc.)

8. Population & Developmental Issues

- Population Growth, Demographic Dividend
- Migration: Causes and Consequences
- Poverty: Types, Causes, Programs (MGNREGA, NFSA)
- Development: Inequality, Sustainable Development

9. Urbanization

- Urban Growth and Problems: Slums, Pollution, Housing
- Smart Cities Mission, AMRUT

- Urban Governance: Municipal Corporations, 74th Amendment

10. Globalization and Indian Society

- Impact on Economy, Culture, Education, Jobs
- Changing Social Values and Family Structure
- Migration, Brain Drain, NRIs

11. Social Empowerment, Communalism, Regionalism, Secularism**A. Social Empowerment**

- SC/ST/OBC Empowerment
- Minority Rights, Rights of Disabled, LGBTQ+

B. Communalism

- Communal Riots, Causes and Solutions
- Role of Media, Politics

C. Regionalism

- Demands for Statehood, Autonomy
- Linguistic and Cultural Identity

D. Secularism

- Constitutional Provisions
- Indian vs Western Secularism
- Issues & Challenges

12. World's Physical Geography**A. Geophysical Phenomena**

- Earthquakes, Volcanoes, Tsunamis
- Plate Tectonics
- Cyclones, El Niño & La Niña

B. Geographical Features & Their Changes

- River Systems, Mountain Ranges
- Melting of Ice Caps, Sea-level Rise
- Deforestation, Desertification

13. Natural Resources & Industry Location**A. Natural Resources Distribution**

- Minerals, Forests, Water Resources (India & World)
- Agricultural Regions

B. Industrial Location Factors

- Primary: Agriculture, Mining
- Secondary: Manufacturing (Steel, Textiles, etc.)
- Tertiary: IT, Services, Tourism

TOPIC-1. Indian Heritage and Culture**A. Art Forms****1. Classical Dances****Quote:**

"Dance is the joy of the soul expressed through movement." — *Rabindranath Tagore*

Introduction:

Rooted in sacred texts, India's classical dances have become a diplomatic tool under *Ek Bharat Shreshtha Bharat* and *Indian Council for Cultural Relations*, linking heritage with India's growing global cultural stature.

Examples:

- *Kuchipudi* showcased at Shanghai cultural expo under *Azadi Ka Amrit Mahotsav*
- *Odissi* included in India's pavilion at the World Tourism Expo

Conclusion:

Schemes like *Kala Sanskriti Vikas Yojana* and art integration in *NEP 2020* are key to preserving traditional forms while fostering India's cultural footprint globally.

2. Folk Dances**Quote:**

"The folk dance is the community's way of telling its own story." — *Kapila Vatsyayan*

Introduction:

Folk dances reflect agrarian rhythms, festivals, and social cohesion. Under *Sanskritik Mahotsav* and *Virasat Programme*, they've been revived as platforms for rural pride and community-led tourism.

Examples:

- *Bihu* featured in G20 cultural evening in Assam
- *Kalbelia* integrated into *District Cultural Mapping* under *Culture Mapping Portal*

Conclusion:

Incentivizing folk forms via *Scheme for Financial Assistance for Promotion of Art and Culture* ensures cultural democracy and rural economic participation.

3. Classical Music**Quote:**

"Indian music is a meditation, not a performance." — *Pandit Ravi Shankar*

Introduction:

Indian classical music bridges temples, courts, and global stages. Supported by *SPIC MACAY*, *IGNCA*, and digital archiving efforts, it blends legacy with modern innovation and international engagement.

Examples:

- *Ustad Amjad Ali Khan's* concerts included in India-Europe cultural diplomacy
- *Carnatic concerts* integrated into cultural tourism circuits under *Dekho Apna Desh*

Conclusion:

Expanding *Guru-Shishya Parampara Scheme* and leveraging digital platforms ensures continuity of this rich sonic heritage in contemporary society.

4. Folk Music**Quote:**

"A nation's folk music is its heartbeat." — *Jawaharlal Nehru*

Introduction:

Folk music preserves oral history and social memory. With renewed focus under *NEP 2020* and *Kala Utsav*, it now enters classrooms and cultural policy to empower grassroots storytelling.

Examples:

- *Manganiyars* performed during National Teachers' Conclave
- *Baul singers* featured in India's soft power delegation to ASEAN

Conclusion:

Archiving traditions and artist cooperatives, backed by *Sangeet Natak Akademi* and *IGNCA*, will prevent erosion of these living narratives.

5. Theatre

Quote:

"Theatre mirrors society and transforms it." — *Habib Tanvir*

Introduction:

From *Kutiyattam* to *nukkad natak*, Indian theatre blends ritual, resistance, and reform. With *Bharat Rang Mahotsav* and *Performing Arts Grant Scheme*, it resurfaces as a tool for civic dialogue.

Examples:

- *NSD's tribal theatre showcase* conducted in Jharkhand under outreach initiative
- *Street plays on electoral literacy* funded under *Systematic Voters' Education and Electoral Participation* (SVEEP)

Conclusion:

Empowering local theatre and regional scripts can make performing arts a bridge between constitutional values and cultural expression.

6. Puppetry (String, Shadow, Glove, Rod)

Quote:

"In puppetry, silent hands speak louder than words." — *Satyajit Ray*

Introduction:

India's puppetry once educated villages before formal schooling. Now, with digital revival through *Indira Gandhi National Centre for the Arts* and inclusion in *Heritage Education programs*, it regains relevance.

Examples:

- *Tholu Bommalata* incorporated in AR exhibitions by Ministry of Culture
- *Kathputli artists* featured in urban storytelling festivals across metro cities

Conclusion:

Integrating puppetry in school storytelling and tourism circuits under *Ek Bharat Shreshtha Bharat* offers revival with purpose and pride.

7. Martial Arts

Quote:

"Martial arts train the body to protect and the mind to persevere." — *Bruce Lee*

Introduction:

Martial arts like *Kalaripayattu* and *Gatka* now find place in *Fit India Movement* and *Khelo India Youth Games*, blending heritage with holistic fitness and national pride.

Examples:

- *Kalaripayattu* demo included in *Yoga Mahotsav* opening session
- *Thang-Ta* integrated in youth skill camps under *Sankalp Scheme* in Northeast

Conclusion:

Promoting martial arts as sport, self-defense, and cultural pride can ensure India's ancient combat wisdom thrives among youth.

TOPIC 2: Literature

1. Vedic Literature: Samhitas, Brahmanas, Aranyakas, Upanishads

Quote:

"The Vedas are not books of theology but records of spiritual discovery." – *Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan*

Introduction:

Vedic literature forms the philosophical and ritualistic foundation of Indian civilization. It evolved from hymns in the *Samhitas* to deep metaphysical inquiries in the *Upanishads*, influencing Indian ethics, rituals, and education.

Examples:

- *NEP 2020* encourages Sanskrit and Indic knowledge systems in curricula.
- *Indira Gandhi National Centre for the Arts* digitized Rigveda manuscripts for public access.

Conclusion:

Mainstreaming Vedic texts through digital access and curriculum reforms ensures ancient wisdom nurtures modern minds.

2. Sangam Literature**Quote:**

"Sangam poetry is not just emotion it is geography, economy, and politics in verse." – A.K. Ramanujan

Introduction:

Sangam literature from ancient Tamilakam provides a secular, humanist account of life, love, war, and trade. Its secular themes make it a unique non-Vedic civilizational lens into early South India.

Examples:

- Keeladi excavations linked archaeological findings to literary references.
- Sangam texts featured in PM Museum's civilizational gallery on ancient India.

Conclusion:

Reviving Sangam literature fosters regional pride and offers a counter-narrative to Vedic-centric historiography.

3. Jain and Buddhist Literature**Quote:**

"Silence and simplicity are the roots of liberation." – Mahavira

Introduction:

Jain and Buddhist texts enriched Indian moral philosophy with principles like *Ahimsa*, *Dhamma*, and *Syadvada*. Their literary forms — Tripitakas, Agamas expanded India's ethical and linguistic landscape.

Examples:

- Nav Nalanda Mahavihara translated Pali texts for international students.
- Jain Agamas included in National Mission for Manuscripts preservation.

Conclusion:

Ethical universality and pan-Asian influence make these texts vital to India's global soft power.

4. Medieval Bhakti and Sufi Literature**Quote:**

"Kabir's words cut sharper than a sword, yet stitch together a divided world." – Rabindranath Tagore

Introduction:

Bhakti and Sufi literature democratized religion by prioritizing love and personal devotion over rituals. Through regional languages and metaphors, saints unified society beyond caste and creed.

Examples:

- Sant Kabir Akademi set up under Scheme for Promotion of Culture of Saints.
- Sufi literature festivals held in Rajasthan promoted cultural harmony.

Conclusion:

Their teachings remain relevant in today's fractured socio-religious landscape, guiding inclusive nationalism.

5. Persian Literature in India**Quote:**

"Persian in India was not just a language, it was the canvas for Indo-Islamic creativity." – Muzaffar Alam

Introduction:

Persian thrived as India's administrative and literary language during the Delhi Sultanate and Mughals. It produced historical chronicles, poetry, and translations that bridged cultures and preserved statecraft.

Examples:

- Ain-i-Akbari featured in National Archives digitization project.
- Maulana Azad Centre for Persian Studies promotes research in Persian literary heritage.

Conclusion:

Persian literature is a reminder of India's cultural syncretism and needs sustained academic support.

6. Modern Indian Literature (Bengali Renaissance, Regional Literature)**Quote:**

"A nation is built by those who write its soul into words." – Rabindranath Tagore

Introduction:

Modern Indian literature evolved through the Bengal Renaissance and flourished regionally, reflecting reformist ideas, nationalism, and social realism a bridge from colonial critique to cultural awakening.

Examples:

- Sahitya Akademi's *Bhasha Samman* celebrates contributions in tribal and regional languages.
- *Ek Bharat Shreshtha Bharat* initiative promotes inter-state literary exchanges.

Conclusion:

Contemporary Indian literature must balance rooted identity with cosmopolitan values for nation-building.

Topic C: Architecture**1. Ancient Architecture: Harappan, Mauryan, Gupta, Temple (Nagara, Dravida, Vesara)****Quote:**

"The story of India is written in stone." – John Marshall

Introduction:

From the urban planning of Harappa to Gupta cave shrines and Nagara-Dravida temples, ancient Indian architecture reflected both material sophistication and spiritual imagination that shaped civilizational aesthetics.

Examples:

- *Rakhigarhi Museum* and Harappan gallery by *Archaeological Survey of India*.
- *PRASAD* scheme revitalized ancient temple sites like Srisailam and Mahakaleshwar.

Conclusion:

Preserving ancient sites through archaeological and tourism initiatives ensures India's roots continue to inspire modern identity.

2. Medieval Architecture: Indo-Islamic (Delhi Sultanate, Mughal)**Quote:**

"The Taj is a tear on the cheek of time." – Rabindranath Tagore

Introduction:

Medieval architecture blended Persian, Turkish, and Indian elements from Qutub Minar to Humayun's Tomb shaping India's syncretic aesthetics in stone, calligraphy, and gardens.

Examples:

- *Humayun's Tomb* restoration under *Aga Khan Trust* and *Ministry of Culture*.
- *Azadi Ka Amrit Mahotsav* featured 3D walks through Indo-Islamic monuments.

Conclusion:

These structures reflect cultural confluence and should be positioned as symbols of pluralism in heritage education.

3. Modern Architecture: British Era & Post-Independence**Quote:**

"We shape our buildings; thereafter they shape us." – Winston Churchill

Introduction:

From colonial Indo-Gothic to Charles Correa's post-colonial works, modern Indian architecture mirrors a transition from imperial order to democratic imagination.

Examples:

- *Central Vista Redevelopment Project* reflects new architectural symbolism.
- *INTACH* works to conserve colonial and early modern urban heritage zones.

Conclusion:

Modern architecture must balance innovation with contextual heritage, serving both utility and national ethos.

II. Modern Indian History (Mid-18th Century to Present)**A. British Expansion in India****1. Decline of the Mughal Empire****Quote:**

"The Mughal Empire is now a name. It has no power." — Warren Hastings

Introduction:

The decline of the Mughal Empire stemmed from weak successors, rising regional powers, and administrative collapse opening the doors for European interference and British dominance.

Examples:

- Successive rulers post-Aurangzeb failed to control rising powers like the Marathas and Sikhs.
- Regional nawabs of Awadh, Bengal, and Hyderabad began asserting autonomy by mid-18th century.

Conclusion:

The Mughal decline didn't just mark imperial fall it signalled the beginning of a fragmented India, ripe for colonial conquest through trade, treaties, and tactics.

2. Major Battles (Plassey, Buxar, Anglo-Mysore, Anglo-Maratha, etc.)**Quote:**

"The British won India not by power alone, but by playing Indian politics better than the Indians." — Ramachandra Guha

Introduction:

The colonial conquest of India was paved less by sheer warfare and more by strategic alliances and betrayals. Key battles like Plassey and Buxar marked turning points in the British economic and political dominance.

Examples:

- *Battle of Plassey (1757)*: Laid the foundation of British political supremacy after the betrayal of Nawab Siraj-ud-Daulah.
- *Battle of Buxar (1764)*: Gave the British *Diwani rights* of Bengal, Bihar, and Orissa the financial base for empire-building.
- *Anglo-Mysore Wars*: Showed fierce resistance by Tipu Sultan, now symbolically remembered in Karnataka's cultural politics.
- *Anglo-Maratha Wars*: Dismantled the Maratha confederacy; British annexation sealed with the *Treaty of Bassein*.

Conclusion:

These battles reshaped India's destiny not just as wars, but as tactical losses of sovereignty. Understanding them informs debates on colonial legacy, federalism, and military diplomacy today.

3. Subsidiary Alliance and Doctrine of Lapse**Quote:**

"Every annexation was a blow to India's unity; every alliance, a nail in its autonomy." — Bipan Chandra

Introduction:

With war-fatigue setting in, the British empire turned to political mechanisms like the *Subsidiary Alliance* and *Doctrine of Lapse* policies that undermined Indian sovereignty under the guise of diplomacy.

Examples:

- *Subsidiary Alliance* (Lord Wellesley): Forced Indian rulers like those of Hyderabad and Awadh to maintain British troops and surrender foreign policy.
- *Doctrine of Lapse* (Lord Dalhousie): Annexed Jhansi, Satara, and Nagpur, disregarding local succession rights fueling resentment that echoed in 1857.
- *Rani Lakshmbai's resistance* remains an iconic legacy of anti-imperial defiance tied to this policy.

Conclusion:

These 'non-violent' policies were strategic tools of conquest that sowed deep political discontent. Their fallout helped unite princely states in resistance and continues to echo in India's federal memory.

B. Colonial Administration & Policies**1. Administrative Reforms**

Quote:

“Good governance depends on ability, not birth.” – Jawaharlal Nehru

Intro:

The British laid the foundations of centralized administration in India through regulatory and legislative acts, shaping civil services and institutions that influenced India's future governance structure and federal setup.

Examples:

- *Indian Civil Services* legacy continues through UPSC's role in selecting public administrators.
- *Government of India Act, 1935* served as the template for India's constitutional architecture.

Conclusion:

Though colonial in intent, these reforms enabled India's administrative continuity post-1947. *Mission Karmayogi* builds on this legacy for a citizen-centric bureaucracy.

2. Land Revenue Systems: Zamindari, Ryotwari, Mahalwari**Quote:**

“The misery hardly finds vent in words... it is so deep.” – Rabindranath Tagore

Intro:

British land revenue systems like Zamindari, Ryotwari, and Mahalwari prioritized revenue over rural welfare, dismantling community land rights and creating structural rural poverty that still echoes in land debates today.

Examples:

- *Digitisation of land records* under *Digital India Land Records Modernization Programme* tackles legacy issues from colonial land mapping.
- *PM Kisan Samman Nidhi* offers income support to small farmers in a system once devoid of state welfare.

Conclusion:

Colonial systems extracted without empowering. Land and income-support schemes aim to reverse historical marginalisation and ensure agrarian dignity.

3. Economic Impact of British Rule**Quote:**

“India is a mere agricultural farm for England a nursery of soldiers.” – Dadabhai Naoroji

Intro:

Colonial policies reoriented India from a producer of crafts to a supplier of raw materials, resulting in deindustrialisation, trade imbalance, and impoverishment the foundation of the 'Drain of Wealth' theory.

Examples:

- *One District One Product* initiative revives crafts once destroyed by colonial trade policies.
- *PLI Scheme (Production Linked Incentive)* boosts manufacturing to reclaim India's industrial self-reliance.

Conclusion:

The colonial economy weakened local enterprise. Current industrial policies aim to rebuild India's lost productive capacity.

4. Social and Cultural Impact**Quote:**

“No people can be truly free unless they are educated.” – Swami Vivekananda

Intro:

British rule introduced Western education, new laws, and cultural changes sparking both social reform and resistance. It seeded modern institutions but also fragmented traditional knowledge systems.

Examples:

- *National Education Policy* promotes mother tongue instruction a shift from colonial language imposition.

- *Indian Knowledge Systems* initiative revives indigenous learning once marginalised during British reforms.

Conclusion:

While colonialism disrupted social equilibrium, it also triggered reformist thought. Today's policies aim to balance global skills with indigenous identity.

C. Social and Religious Reform Movements**1. Brahmo Samaj, Arya Samaj, Aligarh Movement****Quote:**

"The condition of women is the true measure of a nation's progress." – Swami Vivekananda

Intro:

These 19th-century reform movements sought to balance modernity and tradition. While *Brahmo Samaj* and *Arya Samaj* challenged religious orthodoxy, the *Aligarh Movement* focused on educational upliftment of Muslims.

Examples:

- *Nai Manzil Scheme* targets education for minority communities, carrying forward Sir Syed Ahmad Khan's vision.
- *Gender sensitisation programs* in NEP 2020 reflect Raja Ram Mohan Roy's advocacy for women's rights.

Conclusion:

These movements created an informed civil society. Current educational and reform efforts echo their inclusive and progressive spirit.

2. Role of Women Reformers**Quote:**

"Awake, arise and educate. Smash traditions – liberate." – Savitribai Phule

Intro:

Women like Savitribai Phule, Pandita Ramabai, and Rokeya Sakhawat Hossain led social reform not just by challenging patriarchy but by building educational and institutional alternatives.

Examples:

- *Beti Bachao Beti Padhao* aligns with the vision of educational empowerment pioneered by these reformers.
- *Mahila Samman Savings Certificate Scheme* promotes financial inclusion, echoing calls for women's agency.

Conclusion:

These pioneers redefined reform from the margins. Today's women-centric schemes draw directly from their legacy of grassroots empowerment.

D. Key Personalities**1. Gandhi, Nehru, Tilak, Bose, Ambedkar, Savitribai Phule****Quote:**

"A nation's culture resides in the hearts and in the soul of its people." — Mahatma Gandhi

Introduction:

These leaders weren't mere freedom fighters but architects of India's moral, constitutional, and educational framework. Their visions continue to inform India's democratic ethos, grassroots reform, and inclusive policy thinking.

Examples:

- *Mera Yuva Bharat (MY Bharat)* invokes Swami Vivekananda and Tilak's youth nationalism, fostering civic participation.

- *Ambedkar Social Innovation Incubation Mission* empowers Dalit entrepreneurs, reflecting Ambedkar's vision of social mobility through education and enterprise.

Conclusion:

Their philosophies are not relics but living ideas embedded in India's Constitution, development schemes, and social equity narratives that continue to shape India's journey.

2. Regional Leaders and Revolutionaries**Quote:**

"It is our duty to pay for our liberty with our own blood." — Subhas Chandra Bose

Introduction:

While national icons led ideologically, it was regional leaders and revolutionaries who ignited local rebellions and inspired grassroots nationalism decentralising the freedom movement into a true people's struggle.

Examples:

- *PM Janman Yojana* focuses on Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups, aligning with Birsa Munda's legacy of tribal assertion.
- *Digital Museum of Unsung Heroes* honours figures like Kanaklata Barua and Veer Surendra Sai, filling gaps in popular memory.

Conclusion:

Commemorating these figures democratizes history and revives collective memory transforming freedom from a narrative of few into the legacy of many.

3. The Freedom Struggle**A. Early Phase of Freedom Struggle****Quote:**

"The seeds of freedom must be sown in the soil of unity." — Gopal Krishna Gokhale

Introduction:

The early nationalist phase laid India's constitutional foundations, with debates over reform vs. resistance. From 1857's rebellion to INC's formation, it marked India's awakening into political consciousness.

Examples:

- *Azadi Ka Amrit Mahotsav* exhibitions at museums now highlight contributions of early moderates and leaders like Dadabhai Naoroji.
- *Indian Council of Historical Research* recently funded studies reframing 1857 as the "First War of Independence" in school curricula.

Conclusion:

Though incremental, this phase ignited national identity and political awareness — becoming the intellectual bedrock for mass resistance to come.

B. Gandhian Phase**Quote:**

"You may never know what results come of your actions, but if you do nothing, there will be no result." — Mahatma Gandhi

Introduction:

Gandhi transformed politics into mass participation from salt to spinning wheel, India's fight became moral, inclusive, and decentralised, redefining the freedom struggle into a people's movement.

Examples:

- *Khadi Mahotsav* campaigns use digital storytelling to promote Gandhian economic self-reliance.
- *National Digital Archives* launched new modules on Dandi March and Quit India for school outreach.

Conclusion:

The Gandhian phase institutionalised ahimsa as strategy and swaraj as vision — sowing the values that now anchor India's democratic soul.

C. Revolutionary Movements**Quote:**

"They may kill me, but they cannot kill my ideas." — Bhagat Singh

Introduction:

Revolutionaries lit the fire when moderation failed. Their sacrifices, from bomb factories to courtrooms, shook colonial arrogance and symbolised youth-led urgency for complete independence.

Examples:

- *Digital Museum on Revolutionaries* launched in Delhi features rare HSRA manifestos.
- *Statue installations* of Chandrasekhar Azad and Ashfaqulla Khan added to revamped public history trails.

Conclusion:

Though short-lived, these movements brought unmatched moral courage forcing the empire to acknowledge the cost of denying Indian freedom.

D. Role of Subalterns**Quote:**

"The soul of India lives in its villages." — Mahatma Gandhi

Introduction:

Beyond elite platforms, peasants, tribals, women, and Dalits carried the struggle into forests, fields, and homes — converting freedom into a lived, localised resistance against both colonial and social oppression.

Examples:

- *Tribal Freedom Fighter Museum* initiatives narrate unsung uprisings like Santhal and Bhil revolts.
- *Mera Gaon, Mera Gaurav* uses village-level storytelling to document women and lower-caste leaders in local archives.

Conclusion:

True freedom emerged not just from speeches, but from the sweat of the subalterns their legacy must be centred in our national memory.

E. Contributions from Different Regions**Quote:**

"Freedom is not given, it is taken." — Subhas Chandra Bose

Introduction:

From Bengal's intellectual fervour to Punjab's martyrdom, and South India's press to Northeast's uprisings every region added its own rhythm to India's national anthem of resistance.

Examples:

- *Freedom Trail Programmes* in Northeast India map regional heroes like Rani Gaidinliu and Kanaklata Barua.
- *Heritage City walks* in Tamil Nadu revive freedom-era printing presses and underground networks.

Conclusion:

India's freedom was a chorus, not a solo. Recognising regional contributions enriches our pluralistic legacy and strengthens national integration.

4. Post-Independence Consolidation and Reorganization**A. Integration of Princely States****Quote:**

"The problem of the Indian States is so complex that it would baffle any statesman." – Jawaharlal Nehru

Introduction:

The political unification of over 560 princely states post-independence was India's first internal challenge. Sardar Patel's diplomacy, aided by civil servants and the military, forged a coherent union from fragmented sovereignties.

Examples:

- *Statue of Unity complex* now features digital exhibits on the Hyderabad and Junagadh integrations.
- *Civic curriculum updates* under National Education Policy include case studies on Sardar Patel's unification efforts.

Conclusion:

Patel's realpolitik saved India from Balkanization. Political consolidation created the platform for democratic deepening and institutional stability in a newly free nation.

B. Reorganization of States**Quote:**

"Language is the basis of culture; culture is the identity of people." – C. Rajagopalachari

Introduction:

Balancing linguistic identity with national unity led to the States Reorganisation Act, 1956 a transformative exercise that respected cultural diversity while cementing administrative coherence.

Examples:

- *New parliamentary reports* on linguistic minorities revisit SRC principles to address rising demands in Bundelkhand and Tamil Nadu.
- *Digital linguistic atlases* funded by Ministry of Culture now map dialect diversity in the Northeast and Deccan regions.

Conclusion:

Reorganisation on linguistic lines fostered regional pride without compromising national unity a model of pluralism managed through constitutional structure.

C. Challenges to Nation-Building**Quote:**

"A democracy requires vigilance as much as it requires freedom." – B. R. Ambedkar

Introduction:

Partition trauma, refugee influx, communalism, secessionist threats, and the 1975 Emergency all tested India's democratic foundations yet the Republic survived by adapting and reaffirming its constitutional resilience.

Examples:

- *National Integration Tour Programmes* led by Army in Manipur and J&K aim to engage youth from conflict-prone areas.
- *Emergency@50 awareness series* in school's revisits constitutional amendments and press restrictions to reinforce democratic literacy.

Conclusion:

Nation-building in India was not linear. It demanded course corrections, civic awakening, and constitutional commitment — a legacy that continues to demand reflection and reform.

5. History of the World (from 18th Century)**A. 18th Century Revolutions****Quote:**

"Liberty, equality, fraternity these are not mere words, they are our guiding principles." — Nelson Mandela

Introduction:

Revolutions in America, France, and Haiti redefined governance by challenging monarchy and slavery. They institutionalized people's sovereignty, inspiring modern democracies, and anti-colonial struggles across continents.

Examples:

- *Indian school civics curriculum* included modules on Haitian and French Revolutions as roots of global rights discourse.
- *UN Democracy Dialogue* cited American revolutionary ideals while discussing voter apathy and democratic backsliding.

Conclusion:

These revolutions turned abstract ideals into institutional realities. Their values remain benchmarks for justice, rights, and people-led governance today.

B. Industrial Revolution**Quote:**

"The factory system was the beginning of man being reduced to a number." — Mahatma Gandhi

Introduction:

The Industrial Revolution altered economies and labor, but also widened inequality and colonial dependence. It sowed the seeds for capitalism, environmental degradation, and the modern labor movement.

Examples:

- *Global South Climate Consortium* highlighted industrial-era emissions as root of today's carbon imbalance.
- *India's G20 summit agenda* linked labor rights with ethical production chains in post-industrial economies.

Conclusion:

It mechanized growth but dehumanized labor. Its legacy forces us to balance innovation with justice and sustainability in a changing world.

C. World Wars**Quote:**

"Those who cannot remember the past are condemned to repeat it." — George Santayana

Introduction:

The World Wars reshaped geopolitics, collapsed empires, and created global institutions. They also radicalized colonies into questioning imperialism and led to multilateral peace frameworks like the United Nations.

Examples:

- *UN General Assembly resolution* reaffirmed League of Nations' failures while discussing reforms for Security Council representation.
- *India-Europe Peace Forum* emphasized lessons from both World Wars in managing refugee crises.

Conclusion:

War left scars and systems. The world must now preserve peace not just through deterrence, but inclusive diplomacy and justice.

D. Colonialism & Decolonization**Quote:**

"The sun never set on the British Empire but it never rose on its justice." — Shashi Tharoor

Introduction:

Colonialism plundered wealth and agency. Decolonization was driven by local movements, post-war fatigue, and global solidarity, shaping today's South-South cooperation and identity politics.

Examples:

- *India-African Union joint statement* called for restitution of cultural artefacts from former colonial powers.
- *South-South Knowledge Exchange Platform* shared post-colonial development models from Asia, Africa, and Latin America.

Conclusion:

Decolonization ended foreign rule, but the colonial mindset lingers. True freedom lies in reclaiming cultural, economic, and intellectual sovereignty.

E. Political Philosophies**Quote:**

"Democracy is the worst form of government except for all the others." — Winston Churchill

Introduction:

Modern ideologies capitalism, socialism, fascism were responses to inequality, freedom, and authority. These philosophies still inform debates on welfare, authoritarianism, and economic justice across global democracies.

Examples:

- *G7 academic roundtable* debated AI governance through capitalist and socialist frameworks.
- *Indian civil service ethics module* uses comparisons of Marx, Smith, and totalitarian regimes to assess leadership philosophies.

Conclusion:

Ideologies shape laws and lives. Understanding their roots is vital to balance liberty, equity, and power in today's multipolar world.

Great! Here's a continuation of the same refined and UPSC-relevant format for:

III. INDIAN SOCIETY**6. Diversity of India****Quote:**

"India is a garden of many flowers — each one beautiful, each one unique." — Jawaharlal Nehru

Introduction:

With *Unity in Diversity* as its soul, India is a mosaic of languages, faiths, ethnicities, and regional identities. This diversity isn't just co-existence; it's the foundation of India's democratic vibrancy.

Examples:

- *Ek Bharat Shreshtha Bharat* promotes cultural exchanges between linguistically and ethnically diverse states.
- The *PM Vishwakarma Yojana* is empowering traditional artisans across cultural communities, preserving pluralistic heritage.

Conclusion:

By celebrating diversity through inclusive policy, India transforms difference into strength a lesson for the world's multicultural democracies.

7. Role of Women & Related Issues**Status of Women: Historical to Modern****Quote:**

"There is no chance for the welfare of the world unless the condition of women is improved." — Swami Vivekananda

Introduction:

From Vedic scholars to constitutional framers, Indian women have shaped history. Today, the journey from *Stree Shakti* to *Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam* reflects a society reclaiming gender equity.

Examples:

- *Women's Reservation in Parliament* was passed to ensure greater representation in lawmaking.
- Over 70% of *Self-Help Group Bank Linkage Programme* beneficiaries are women, redefining economic independence.

Conclusion:

The real empowerment lies in translating rights into realities through laws, leadership, and lasting societal change.

Gender Disparity & Laws/Reforms

Quote:

"A gender-equal society would be one where the word 'gender' does not exist." — Gloria Steinem

Introduction:

While India's legal framework aims for equality, the gap in education, health, and employment shows that *Beti Bachao Beti Padhao* is still a mission, not a milestone.

Examples:

- *STEM for Girls* initiative is addressing educational inequity in science and tech.
- *Mission Shakti* integrates safety, rehabilitation, and empowerment for women under one umbrella.

Conclusion:

Laws can trigger change, but societal mindsets must evolve for true gender justice.

8. Population & Developmental Issues

Population Growth & Migration

Quote:

"Population, when unchecked, increases in a geometrical ratio." — Thomas Malthus

Introduction:

India's demographic transition — from a burden to a dividend — is unfolding. With *Amrit Kaal* vision, managing population growth and migration is crucial for equitable development.

Examples:

- *Viksit Bharat Sankalp Yatra* is focusing on saturation of schemes in high-population districts.
- The *Aspirational Districts Programme* uses population data to reduce migration through local development.

Conclusion:

Harnessing the demographic dividend requires investing in mobility, skills, and balanced urban-rural growth.

Poverty & Development

Quote:

"Poverty is the worst form of violence." — Mahatma Gandhi

Introduction:

India has halved multidimensional poverty through schemes like *National Food Security Act* and *Direct Benefit Transfer*. Yet, inequality demands a reimagining of growth as inclusive and sustainable.

Examples:

- *PM Janman Yojana* targets vulnerable tribal groups often left out of development narratives.
- *One Nation One Ration Card* has improved food access for the mobile poor.

Conclusion:

A just society isn't judged by affluence but by how the poorest live — policy must reflect that truth. Perfect! Continuing in the same enriched, UPSC-relevant style with:

9. Urbanization

Quote:

"A developed country is not a place where the poor have cars. It's where the rich use public transportation." — Enrique Peñalosa

Introduction:

India is witnessing a historic urban shift — where villages aspire to become towns, and cities strive for sustainability. But this urban tide brings challenges of planning, equity, and environment.

Examples:

- *PM e-Bus Sewa* enhances green mobility in tier-2 and tier-3 cities to combat urban congestion and pollution.
- *Affordable Rental Housing Complexes* address migrant housing challenges and slum proliferation.

Conclusion:

Urbanization must be driven by humane planning cities should not just grow, they should include, breathe, and belong.

Urban Governance**Quote:**

"Urban governance is not just administration it is transformation." — E. Sreedharan

Introduction:

With the 74th Constitutional Amendment, urban governance moved closer to people. Yet, real empowerment of local bodies remains uneven across India's complex urban fabric.

Examples:

- *Digital Municipal Platforms* in several states are improving tax collection and service delivery.
- *Capacity-building programs* under AMRUT 2.0 are training urban functionaries in climate resilience and inclusive planning.

Conclusion:

Strong urban governance is the foundation of livable cities it demands devolution, data, and dignity for the urban poor.

10. Globalization and Indian Society**Quote:**

"Think globally, act locally." — Patrick Geddes

Introduction:

Globalization has reshaped India's economy and aspirations integrating it into global value chains, yet also stirring debates on cultural identity and job displacement.

Examples:

- *PLI Schemes* are attracting foreign investment while boosting domestic manufacturing and job creation.
- *Startup India-Digital India synergy* is creating global entrepreneurs from small towns, reshaping societal structures.

Conclusion:

India must embrace globalization on its own terms with rootedness in values and readiness for change.

11-A.Social Empowerment**Quote:**

"Social justice is the first condition of humanity." — B. R. Ambedkar

Introduction:

India's democracy is not just political, it is social as echoed in the Constitution's vision of *"economic and social justice"*. Social empowerment ensures dignity and opportunity beyond just representation.

Examples:

- *PM Vishwakarma Yojana* empowers traditional artisans from Scheduled Castes and Other Backward Classes with modern tools and training.
- *National Action Plan for Transgender Persons* institutionalizes inclusion via healthcare, shelter, and employment support.

Conclusion:

True empowerment transcends schemes it reflects in voices heard, opportunities shared, and dignity restored.

B. Communalism**Quote:**

"Religion is a personal matter, not a political weapon." — Jawaharlal Nehru

Introduction:

India's unity lies in its plurality, yet communalism threatens to fracture it. Communal violence stems not from faith, but from politicized narratives and failure of institutions.

Examples:

- *One Nation, One Police Reform Agenda* focuses on neutralizing bias in local policing to contain communal flare-ups.
- *Social media monitoring cells* across states counter hate speech and misinformation that fuel communal tensions.

Conclusion:

Countering communalism demands not just control, but cultivation of harmony, shared spaces, and common national belonging.

C. Regionalism**Quote:**

"India is a union of states, not a confederation of ambitions." — Sardar Patel

Introduction:

India's diversity is its strength but when regional pride morphs into regionalism, it can challenge the nation's integrative ethos. Balancing identity and unity is a democratic tightrope.

Examples:

- *Special Development Councils* in tribal-majority states celebrate regional culture while ensuring equitable development.
- Recent peaceful movements for statehood have emphasized democratic methods over disruptive agitations.

Conclusion:

A strong India allows space for local identity but never at the cost of national integrity.

D. Secularism**Quote:**

"Secularism is the soul of the Indian Constitution." — Rajendra Prasad

Introduction:

Indian secularism is not the absence of religion it's the equal respect of all. In a society where faiths intertwine, secularism is less a doctrine, more a discipline of governance.

Examples:

- *Scheme for Promotion of Traditional and Indigenous Faiths* in the Northeast protects cultural pluralism.
- The judiciary's recent proactive role in protecting religious freedoms and curbing hate-driven laws reflects constitutional secularism in action.

Conclusion:

Secularism must live not just in laws, but in lived experiences where every faith feels safe, and no belief feels excluded.

12. World's Physical Geography**A. Geophysical Phenomena**

(Earthquakes, Volcanoes, Tsunamis, Plate Tectonics, Cyclones, El Niño & La Niña)

Quote:

"Nature does not hurry, yet everything is accomplished."

Introduction:

The Earth breathes through its disasters earthquakes, tsunamis, and volcanoes are not just calamities, but signatures of dynamic planetary systems. Understanding these phenomena is key to building climate resilience.

Examples:

- *Early Warning Dissemination System* expansion under National Disaster Management Authority is mitigating cyclone impacts in coastal states.
- *ISRO's real-time earthquake monitoring network* is enhancing micro-zonation efforts in seismic-prone zones.

Conclusion:

Mastering geophysical rhythms allows humans not to conquer nature, but to coexist safely with its immense power.

B. Geographical Features & Their Changes

(Rivers, Mountains, Ice Caps, Sea-level Rise, Deforestation, Desertification)

Quote:

"We do not inherit the Earth from our ancestors; we borrow it from our children." Native American Proverb

Introduction:

From the receding glaciers of the Himalayas to encroaching deserts in Rajasthan, Earth's features are reshaping rapidly. These shifts aren't just physical they're ecological alarms demanding action.

Examples:

- *Namami Gange Mission's glacier monitoring extension* now tracks glacial melt rates in Ganga's origin basins.
- *Desertification Atlas of India* triggered targeted afforestation in over 200 drought-prone districts.

Conclusion:

Preserving the Earth's natural face isn't just environmental it's existential for civilizations built around rivers, forests, and coasts.

13. Natural Resources & Industry Location**A. Natural Resources Distribution**

(Minerals, Forests, Water, Agriculture)

Quote:

"Resources are not, they become."

Introduction:

India's prosperity is tied to how it harnesses its endowments from Eastern coal belts to the Western ghats' biodiversity. Resource distribution defines not just geography but also economic destiny.

Examples:

- *District Mineral Foundation* funds are being repurposed to uplift health and education in mining-affected areas.
- *Mera Gaon Mera Gaurav* connects agricultural scientists with resource-poor farmers to optimize cropping in drought-prone belts.

Conclusion:

Equitable use of natural wealth determines whether growth becomes inclusive—or remains a privilege of the well-placed.

B. Industrial Location Factors

(Primary, Secondary, Tertiary Sectors)

Quote:

"Industries go where they are wanted, and stay where they are treated well." — Ronald Reagan

Introduction:

From textile mills near rivers to IT parks in urban cores, industry follows a logic of location raw material, labor, markets, and increasingly, sustainability.

Examples:

- *PLI (Production-Linked Incentive) scheme* has realigned electronics manufacturing hubs toward semi-urban clusters.
- *National Industrial Corridor Development Programme* is reshaping connectivity and boosting tier-2 industrial zones.

Conclusion:

Location is no longer just a matter of proximity it's about policy support, logistics, and sustainability outlook.

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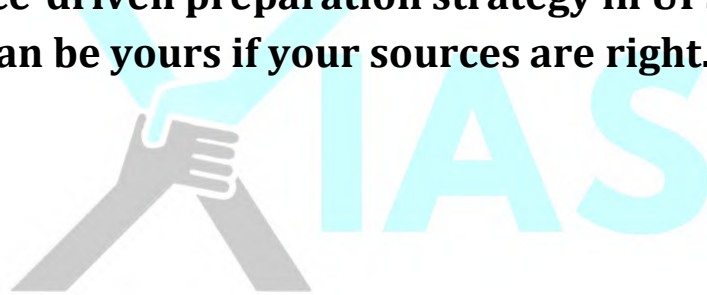
"The difference between a topper and an average aspirant is not effort it's direction."

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14. Who among the following rulers in ancient India had assumed the titles 'Mattavilasa', 'Vichitrachitta' and 'Udambhara'?

- (a) Mahendravarmam I
(b) Simhavishnu
(c) Narasimhavarmam I
(d) Simhavarmam

XIAS
LEVEL-1 RTS
Class Notes
X Lecture

Mahendravarmam I was a follower of Jainism in the early part of his career. He was converted to Saivism by the influence of the Saiva saint, Thirunavukkarasar alias Appar. He built a Siva temple at Tiruvadi. He assumed a number of titles like Gunabhara, Suryasandha, Chettakani (builder of temples) Chitrakarapuli, Vichitrachitta and Mattavilasa.

He ruled from Tamralipti (port @ BoBengal) and Amaravati to Burma, and Indonesia. The ports of south India sent ships to Tenasserim, Trang, Malacca, and Java.

The ancient capital of Thailand was named after Ayodhya.

He performed various Vedic sacrifices, including the Ashvamedha.

A later group of Pallava rulers, Mahendra-varman I (600-630) was. He was a contemporary of Thanesar and curiously enough was also a dramatist and poet, of some being the author of a play 'Mattavilasa-prahasana' (The Delight of the

It was during his reign that some of the finest rock-cut Pallava temples, including the famous temples at Mahabalipuram. Mahendra-varman began

Jaina but was converted to Shaivism by the saint Appar. Mahendra-varman's play was Pulakeshin II.

Varman swept right into the capital of Badami and his occupation of the city claim to the title of 'Vatapikonda', 'the Conqueror of Vatapi'.

Varman's play Mattavilasa was well-known and frequently performed by the actors of

→ RTS LEVEL-2

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13. The irrigation device called 'Araghatta' was

- (a) a water bag made of leather pulled over a pulley
(b) a large wheel with earthen pots tied to the outer ends of its spokes
(c) a larger earthen pot driven by bullocks
(d) a large water bucket pulled up by rope directly by hand

Whether the Persian wheel was in use in early medieval Rajasthan is debated, and hinges on the interpretation of the term 'araghatta'. The key issue is whether the reference is to the Persian wheel or to the *noria*. The *noria* is a wheel which has pots or buckets attached to its rim without a chain for carrying the pots, or a gear mechanism to ensure continuous flow of water. It could only be used to draw water from close to the surface or from a river.



→ Explained in details in BTS class (LEVEL-2)

The Persian wheel, on the other hand, had gears and a chain to carry the pots and was associated with a well. 'araghatta' seems to have been different from an ordinary well (*dhimada*) or a step well (*vapi*). UPSC PYQ.

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6. Consider the following statements :

I. India has joined the Minerals Security Partnership as a member.

II. India is a resource-rich country in all the 30 critical minerals that it has identified.

III. The Parliament in 2023 has amended the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Act, 1957 empowering the Central Government to exclusively auction mining lease and composite license for certain critical minerals.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) I and II only (b) II and III only
(c) I and III only (d) I, II and III

MINERALS SECURITY PARTNERSHIP FINANCE NETWORK

Recent Update: India joined the US-led Minerals Security Partnership (MSP) Finance Network to secure sustainable critical mineral supply chains.

About:

- Global Collaboration: Joint financing body for critical mineral projects worldwide.
- Objectives: Strengthen Indo-Pacific and European cooperation for sustainable supply chains.
- Critical Minerals: Includes lithium, cobalt, nickel, and rare earth elements crucial for modern technologies.

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9. Consider the following statements :

Statement I :

Circular economy reduces the emissions of greenhouse gases.

Statement II :

Circular economy reduces the use of raw materials as inputs.

Statement III :

Circular economy reduces wastage in the production process.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

- (a) Both Statement II and Statement III are correct and both of them explain Statement I
(b) Both Statement II and Statement III are correct but only one of them explains Statement I
(c) Only one of the Statements II and III is correct and that explains Statement I
(d) Neither Statement II nor Statement III is correct

XIAS
Current X-press
Magazine

VOLUNTARY VEHICLE MODERNIZATION PROGRAM

Recent Update: Union Ministry of Road Transport and Highways launched the Vehicle Scrapping Policy

to promote a circular economy in the automotive sector.

About:

- Circular Economy: Aims to reduce raw material consumption and encourage recycling.
- Scrappage Certificate: Provided to owners of unfit vehicles to avail discounts on new purchases.
- Incentives: Discounts of up to 3% for commercial vehicles and 1.5% for passenger vehicles on ex-showroom prices.

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83. Consider the following space missions :

- I. Axiom-4
II. SpaDeX
III. Gaganyaan

How many of the space missions given above encourage and support micro-gravity research?

- (a) Only one (b) Only two
(c) All the three (d) None

GAGANYAAN MISSION

Recent Update: ISRO has selected Gaganyaan astronauts to travel to the International Space Station (ISS) on the Axiom-4 mission, scheduled for October 2024. The mission will be a collaboration with NASA and Axiom Space, utilizing SpaceX's Dragon spacecraft.

About:

- Mission Details: The astronauts will undergo training in the US before the mission.
- Collaboration: India's space program cooperates with NASA and Axiom Space.
- Gaganyaan: India's first human space mission is expected post-2025, after successful uncrewed missions.

AXIOM MISSION 4 (AX-4)

Recent Update: Shubhanshu Shukla and Prasanth Balakrishnan Nair Selected for Axiom-4 mission.

About:

- AX-4: Fourth private astronaut mission to the International Space Station (ISS).
- Duration: 14 days.
- Launch Provider: SpaceX.

SPADEX MISSION

Recent Update: India's SpaDeX mission will demonstrate spacecraft docking technology using PSLV-C50 on December 30.

About SpaDeX Mission:

- What it is: A technology demonstrator for spacecraft docking developed by ISRO.
- Objectives:
 - Primary: Demonstrate rendezvous, docking, and undocking.
 - Secondary: Power transfer between docked spacecraft.
- Technologies:
 - Docking system: Low-impact androgynous.

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48. With reference to monoclonal antibodies, often mentioned in news, consider the following statements :

- I. They are man-made proteins.
- II. They stimulate immunological function due to their ability to bind to specific antigens.
- III. They are used in treating viral infections like that of Nipah virus.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) I and II only
- (b) II and III only
- (c) I and III only
- (d) I, II and III

MONOCLONAL ANTIBODIES

Recent Update: Monoclonal antibodies (mAbs) continue to be widely used in diagnostics, treatments, and cell analysis, offering targeted therapies for diseases like cancer and autoimmune disorders.

About:

- Monoclonal antibodies (mAbs) are lab-made proteins designed to mimic natural antibodies.
- Antibodies are part of the immune system, targeting and destroying foreign materials (antigens).
- Key applications include:
 1. Diagnostics (e.g., ELISA),
 2. Treating diseases such as cancer, infections, and autoimmune disorders,
 3. Cell analysis in blood/tissue using fluorescent tags.

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24. Consider the following statements about turmeric during the year 2022-23 :

- I. India is the largest producer and exporter of turmeric in the world.
- II. More than 30 varieties of turmeric are grown in India.
- III. Maharashtra, Telangana, Karnataka and Tamil Nadu are major turmeric producing States in India.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) I and II only
- (b) II and III only
- (c) I and III only
- (d) I, II and III

NATIONAL TURMERIC BOARD ESTABLISHED

Recent Update: The National Turmeric Board has been launched to support turmeric production and export.

About:

- Objectives: Farmer welfare, R&D, export promotion, quality control.
- India's Dominance: Produces 70% of the world's turmeric.
- Key Regions: Maharashtra, Telangana, Meghalaya.

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96. Which organization has enacted the Nature Restoration Law (NRL) to tackle climate change and biodiversity loss?

- (a) The European Union
- (b) The World Bank
- (c) The Organization for Economic Cooperation and Development
- (d) The Food and Agriculture Organization

EU NATURE RESTORATION LAW

Recent Update: The EU Nature Restoration Law has come into force.

About:

- First continent-wide legislation for nature restoration.
- Targets to restore 20% of degraded ecosystems by 2030, and 100% by 2050.
- Member States must prepare National Restoration Plans by 1st September 2026.
- Legally binding targets:
 - 30% of terrestrial, coastal, freshwater, and marine ecosystems to be restored by 2030.
 - 25,000 km of rivers to be restored to free-flowing status by 2030.
 - Plant three billion trees by 2030.

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30. Consider the following statements about the Rashtriya Gokul Mission :

- I. It is important for the upliftment of rural poor as majority of low producing indigenous animals are with small and marginal farmers and landless labourers.
- II. It was initiated to promote indigenous cattle and buffalo rearing and conservation in a scientific and holistic manner.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) I only
- (b) II only
- (c) Both I and II
- (d) Neither I nor II

RASHTRIYA GOKUL MISSION

Recent Update:

The Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry & Dairying highlighted the Rashtriya Gokul Mission (RGM) for indigenous bovine conservation and milk production.

About:

- RGM was launched in 2014 as part of the Rashtriya Pashudhan Vikas Yojna with a budget of Rs. 1400 crore (2021-2026).
- Aims to conserve indigenous bovine breeds like Punganur for climate resilience and high-quality milk production.
- Focuses on increasing genetic diversity, supporting Artificial Insemination (AI), and conservation efforts.
- Introduces National Digital Livestock Mission to enhance data management and services.

88. Consider the following statements :

- I. If any question arises as to whether a Member of the House of the People has become subject to disqualification under the 10th Schedule, the President's decision in accordance with the opinion of the Council of Union Ministers shall be final.
- II. There is no mention of the word 'political party' in the Constitution of India.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) I only
- (b) II only
- (c) Both I and II
- (d) Neither I nor II

POWERS OF SPEAKER

- The Speaker, elected by a simple majority, has a key constitutional role, including overseeing the House, casting votes, and dealing with member disqualification.
- The Speaker has vast powers in conducting the House, deciding on questions, expunging remarks, and ensuring impartiality in procedures.
- The Speaker's casting vote resolves tie votes, typically favoring the government.

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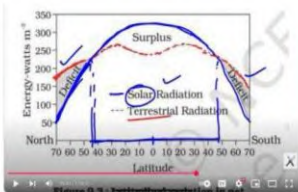
BTS
GEOGRAPHYALLO
FREE
YOUTUBE
CLASSES

29. Consider the following statements :

- I. Without the atmosphere, temperature would be well below freezing point everywhere on the Earth's surface.
- II. Heat absorbed and trapped by the atmosphere maintains our planet's average temperature.
- III. Atmosphere's gases, like carbon dioxide, are particularly good at absorbing and trapping radiation.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) I and III only
- (b) I and II only
- (c) I, II and III
- (d) II and III only



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84. With reference to India's defence, consider the following pairs :

Aircraft type	Description
I. Dornier-228	: Maritime patrol aircraft
II. IL-76	: Supersonic combat aircraft
III. C-17 Globemaster III	: Military transport aircraft

How many of the pairs given above are correctly matched?

- (a) Only one
- (b) Only two
- (c) All the three
- (d) None

ZORAWAR LIGHT TANK

Recent Update: The DRDO successfully completed the first phase of developmental field trials for the Zorawar Light Tank, designed for high-altitude deployment, especially in Ladakh.

About:

- Tested in desert terrain, met all performance goals.
- Developed by CVRDE and L&T.
- Weights 25 tonnes, highly mobile and versatile.
- Can be transported by C-17 aircraft.
- Integrates technologies like unmanned systems and loitering munition.

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27. Consider the following statements :

Statement I :

In January, in the Northern Hemisphere, the isotherms bend equatorward while crossing the landmasses, and poleward while crossing the oceans.

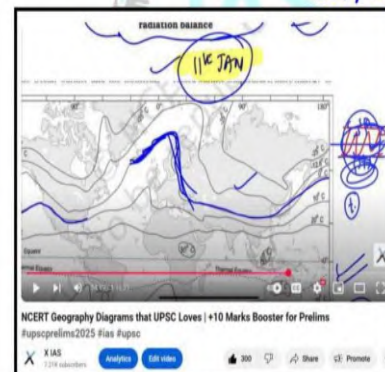
Statement II :

In January, the air over the oceans is warmer than that over the landmasses in the Northern Hemisphere.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

- (a) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct and Statement II explains Statement I
- (b) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct but Statement II does not explain Statement I
- (c) Statement I is correct but Statement II is not correct
- (d) Statement I is not correct but Statement II is correct

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20. Consider the following statements in respect of the Non-Cooperation Movement :

- I. The Congress declared the attainment of 'Swaraj' by all legitimate and peaceful means to be its objective.
- II. It was to be implemented in stages with civil disobedience and non-payment of taxes for the next stage only if 'Swaraj' did not come within a year and the Government resorted to repression.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) I only
- (b) II only
- (c) Both I and II
- (d) Neither I nor II

September 1920 At a **special session in Calcutta** the Congress approved a non-cooperation programme till the Panch and Khilafat wrongs were removed and swaraj was established. The programme was to include—

- boycott of government schools and colleges;
- boycott of law courts and dispensation of justice through panchayats instead;
- boycott of legislative councils (there were some differences over this as some leaders like C.R. Das were not willing to include a boycott of councils, but bowed to Congress discipline; these leaders boycotted elections held in November 1920 and the majority of the voters too stayed away);
- boycott of foreign cloth and use of khadi instead; also practice of hand-spinning to be done;
- **renunciation of government honours and titles;**
- **refusal to include mass civil disobedience including resignation from government service, and acceptance of arrest.**

During the Congress, the participants were supposed to work for Hindu-Muslim unity and for removal of untouchability, all the time remaining non-violent.

December 1920 At the **Haripur session** of the Indian National Congress—

- (i) The programme of non-cooperation was endorsed.
- (ii) An important change **was made in the Congress creed now aimed at lifting the attainment of self-government from constitutional means as its goal.** The Congress decided to have the attainment of swaraj through **political and economic means**, thus committing itself to a **non-constitutional mass struggle.**

(iii) Local level preparatory changes were made: a **congress working committee (CWC) of 15 members** was set up to lead the Congress from now onwards; **provincial congress committees on linguistic basis were organised.**

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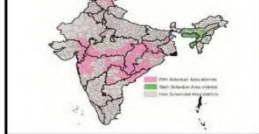
56. Consider the following statements :

- I. With reference to the Constitution of India, if an area in a State is declared as Scheduled Area under the Fifth Schedule
- II. the State Government loses its executive power in such area and a local body assumes total administration
- III. the Union Government can take over the total administration of such areas under certain circumstances on the recommendations of the Governor

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) I only
- (b) II only
- (c) Both I and II
- (d) Neither I nor II

- 10 states have notified Fifth Schedule areas, covering districts in Andhra Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Gujarat, Himachal Pradesh, Jharkhand, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, Odisha, Rajasthan, and Telangana.



PESA Act, 2006

Recent Update: A recent study has found that providing political representation and decision-making power to tribal populations through acts like PESA has supported forest conservation in India's Scheduled Areas.

About:

The PESA Act, enacted on 24th December 1996, aims to ensure self-governance for people in tribal areas (Scheduled Areas) through traditional village assemblies, or Gram Sabhas, a network of Panchayats provisions to tribal areas in Fifth Schedule states.

Legislation:

- The Act defines Scheduled Areas as those under Article 243(i), which applies to areas and tribes in states other than Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura, and Mizoram.
- Scheduled Areas are those notified by the President as Government of India.

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56. Which one of the following launched the **Nature Solutions Finance Hub for Asia and the Pacific?**

- (a) The Asian Development Bank (ADB)
- (b) The Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB)
- (c) The New Development Bank (NDB)
- (d) The International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD)

ASIA-PACIFIC CLIMATE REPORT 2024

Recent Update: The Asian Development Bank (ADB) highlighted alarming economic impacts of climate change on the Asia-Pacific region in the 2024 report.

About:

- **Economic Impact:** APAC could face a 17% GDP reduction by 2070 under high emissions scenarios.
- **Country-specific Risks:**
 - India: 24.7% GDP decline by 2070.
 - Bangladesh: 30.5% GDP loss.
 - Vietnam: 30.2% reduction.
 - Indonesia: 26.8% decline.
- **Long-term Projections:** Potential 41% GDP loss by 2100.

18 of 40

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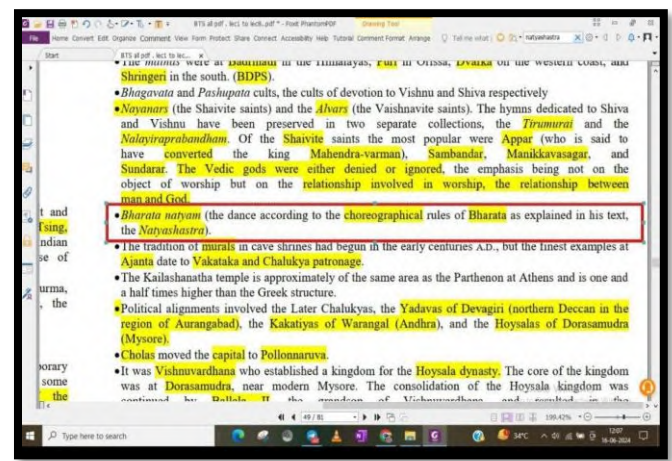
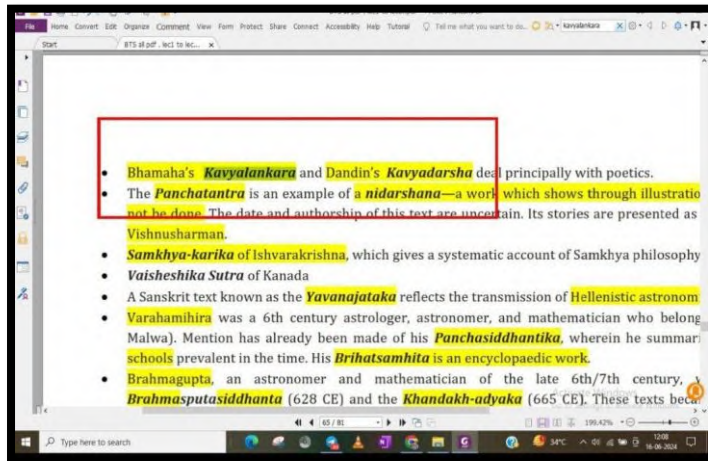
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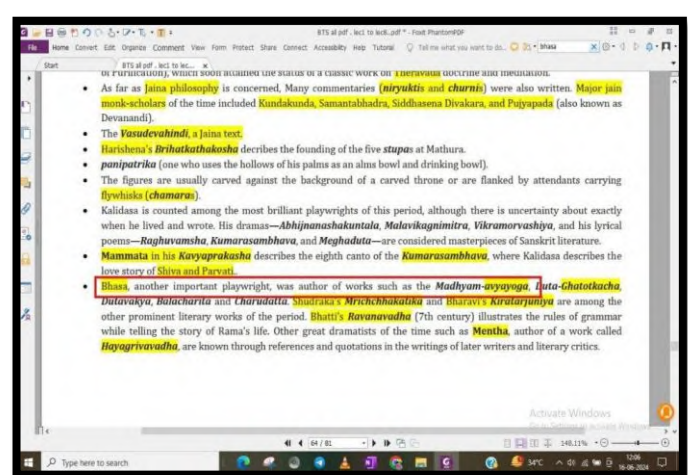
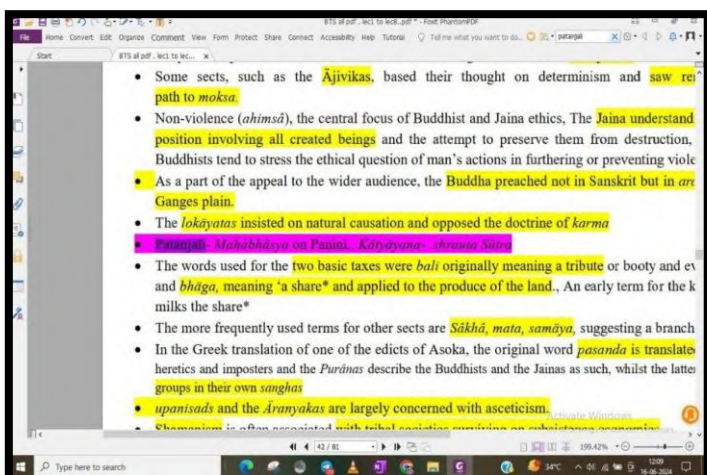
33 Which one of the following is a work attributed to playwright Bhasa?

(a) ~~Kavyalankara~~ Swapaamsha

(b) ~~Natyashastra~~ Playwright

(c) ~~Madhyama-vyayoga~~ Buddhist Tone

(d) ~~Mahabhashya~~ Ratanjali

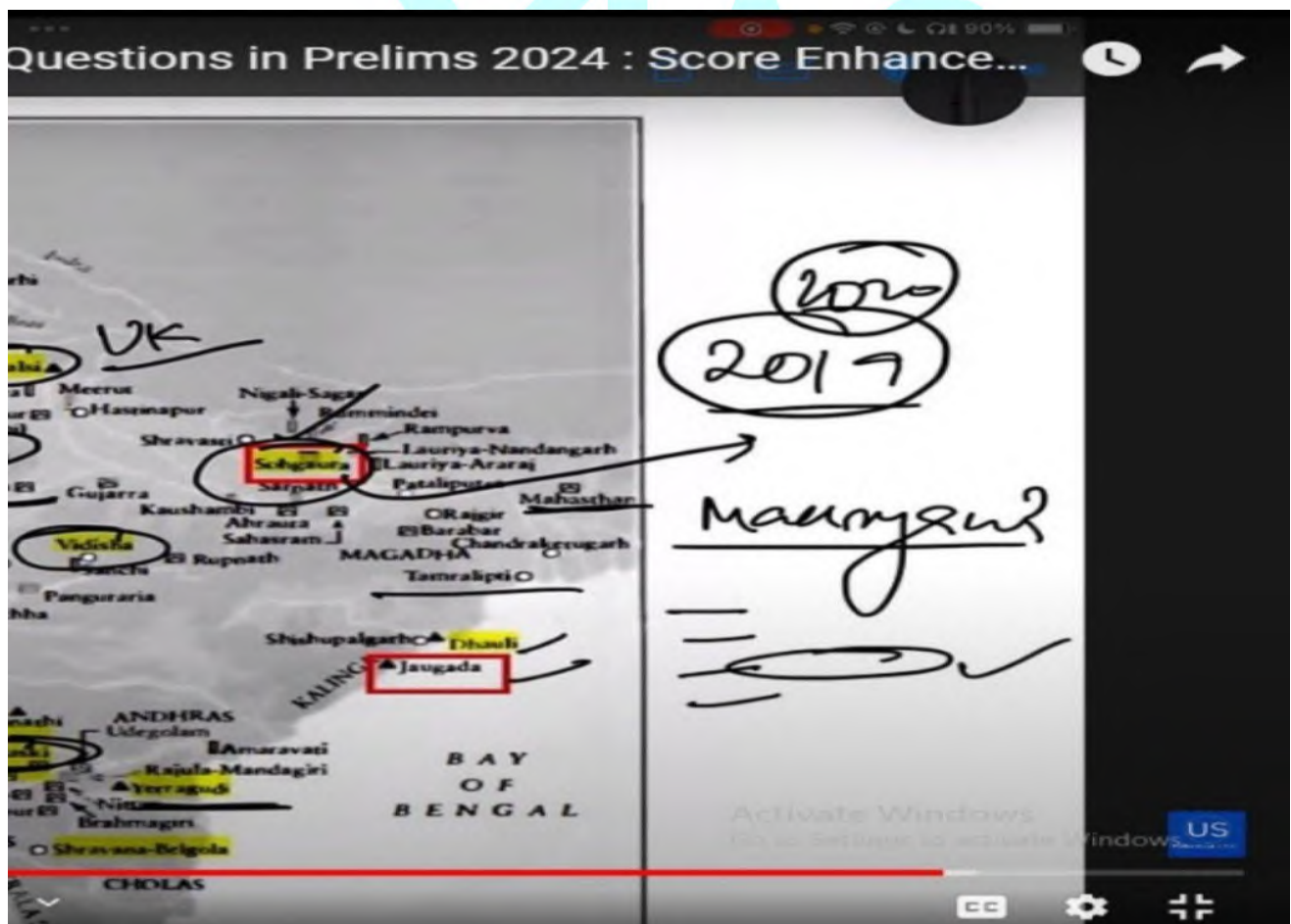
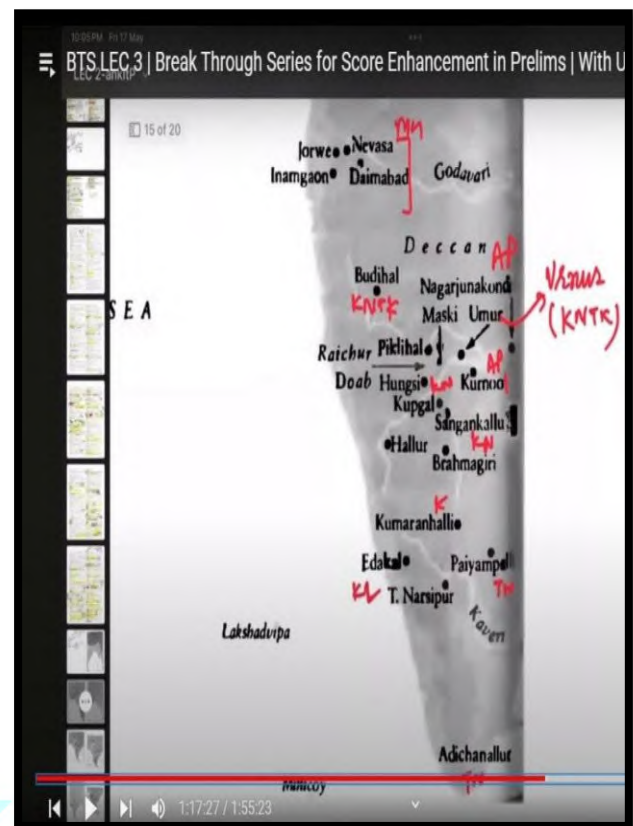


55. Consider the following information :

Archaeological Site	State	Description
1. Chandraketugarh	Odisha	Trading Port town
2. Inamgaon	Maharashtra	Chalcolithic site
3. Mangadu	Kerala	Megalithic site
4. Salihundam	Andhra Pradesh	Rock-cut cave shrines

In which of the above rows is the given information correctly matched ?

- (a) 1 and 2
 (b) 2 and 3
 (c) 3 and 4
 (d) 1 and 4

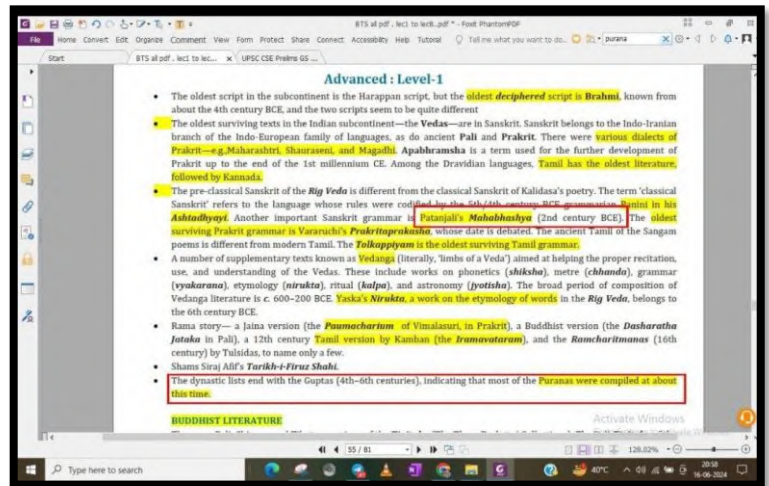


58. Consider the following statements :

1. There are no parables in Upanishads.
2. Upanishads were composed earlier than the Puranas.

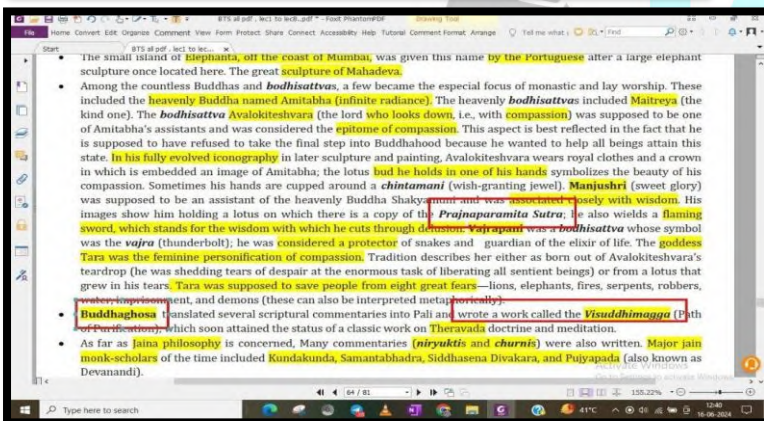
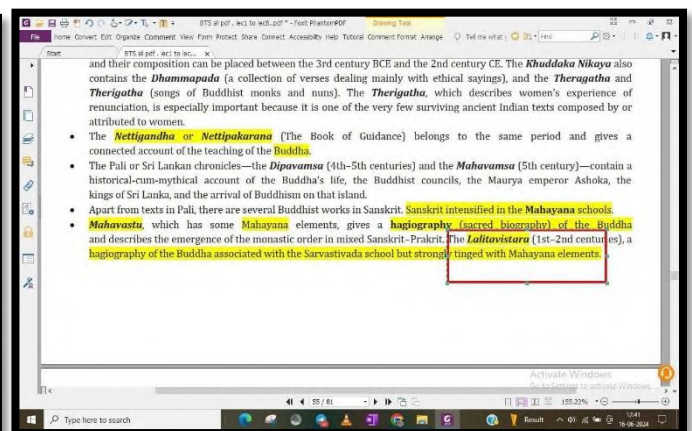
Which of the statements given above is/are correct ?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2



Sanghabhuti, an Indian Buddhist monk, who travelled to China at the end of the fourth century AD, was the author of a commentary on :

- (a) Prajnaparamita Sutra
- (b) Visuddhimagga
- (c) Sarvastivada Vinaya
- (d) Lalitavistara



With reference to ancient India, Gautama Buddha was generally known by which of the following epithets?

1. Nayaputta
2. Shakyamuni
3. Tathagata

Select the correct answer using the codes given below :

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1, 2 and 3
- (d) None of the above are epithets of Gautama Buddha

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